

CENTRAL BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION — PRACTICE EXAMINATION**CLASS IX • SOCIAL SCIENCE (SUBJECT CODE: 087) • ACADEMIC SESSION 2026-27****SET D — ASSERTION & REASONING SPECIAL****CHAPTER 07: ELECTIONS****TIME ALLOWED: 45 MINUTES****MAXIMUM MARKS: 25 MARKS****SERIES: CBS-IX-SST-SET-D-07****Student's Name:** _____**Roll No.:** _____**Class & Section:** Class IX - _____**Date of Exam:** _____**Invigilator's Sign:** _____**General Instructions (SET D - Assertion & Reasoning Special):**

1. The question paper comprises **25 Assertion-Reasoning Questions** of **1 mark each**.
2. Each question consists of two statements — **Assertion (A)** and **Reason (R)**.
3. Select the correct option from the following 4 standardized choices:
 - **(A)** Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
 - **(B)** Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
 - **(C)** Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false.
 - **(D)** Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.
4. **Section A (Q1 – Q10):** Core Concepts & Theoretical Principles.
5. **Section B (Q11 – Q18):** Evidentiary Proofs, Case Inferences & Historical/Geographical Mechanisms.
6. **Section C (Q19 – Q25):** Advanced Conceptual Nuances & Institutional/Analytical Complexities.
7. All questions are compulsory. There is no negative marking.
8. Darken the corresponding bubble on the **OMR Sheet** completely using a blue/black ballpoint pen.

STANDARD DIRECTIONS FOR ALL 25 ASSERTION & REASONING QUESTIONS:

- (A)** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(B) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is NOT the correct explanation of (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false.
(D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

SECTION A: CORE THEORETICAL PRINCIPLES (Q.1 TO Q.10) [10 MARKS]**Q.1****Assertion (A):** Elections are essential for the functioning of a modern representative democracy.**Reason (R):** Citizens cannot assemble daily to govern directly and therefore require regular elections to choose representatives who will legislate and form government policies.

- (A)** Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). **(B)** Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. **(D)** Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.2

Assertion (A): In India, elections to the Lok Sabha follow the First-Past-The-Post (FPTP) electoral system.

Reason (R): In the FPTP system, the candidate who secures the highest number of votes in a single-member constituency is declared elected, even without an absolute majority.

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.3

Assertion (A): The Delimitation Commission in India demarcates constituency boundaries based on the latest census population figures.

Reason (R): Constituencies are delineated so that each parliamentary seat represents approximately equal population numbers, upholding 'one person, one value'.

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.4

Assertion (A): The Constitution of India reserves specific legislative constituencies exclusively for Scheduled Castes (SC) and Scheduled Tribes (ST).

Reason (R): Reserved seats ensure that historically marginalized communities receive fair political representation and are not perpetually outvoted in open contests.

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.5

Assertion (A): In a reserved SC constituency, only voters belonging to the Scheduled Caste community are legally permitted to vote.

Reason (R): All eligible registered voters living in the reserved constituency cast their votes, but only candidates belonging to the designated SC category can contest.

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.6

Assertion (A): Every Indian citizen who has attained the age of 18 years possesses the constitutional right to vote in general elections.

Reason (R): The 61st Constitutional Amendment Act of 1988 lowered the voting age in India from 21 years to 18 years.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.7

Assertion (A): A person convicted of serious criminal offences and sentenced to imprisonment for more than two years can still contest Lok Sabha elections.

Reason (R): Under Section 8 of the Representation of the People Act, 1951, a person convicted and sentenced to two or more years of imprisonment is disqualified from contesting.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.8

Assertion (A): Candidates contesting elections in India are legally required to file a sworn affidavit disclosing their criminal antecedents, assets, and liabilities.

Reason (R): Mandatory affidavit disclosures empower voters to make informed choices based on the candidate's integrity and financial transparency.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.9

Assertion (A): The minimum eligible age to vote in India is identical to the minimum eligible age to contest a Lok Sabha parliamentary seat.

Reason (R): The minimum age to vote is 18 years, whereas a citizen must be at least 25 years of age to contest an election for the Lok Sabha.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.10

Assertion (A): The Voters' List (Electoral Roll) is revised and updated periodically by the Election Commission of India.

Reason (R): Periodic revision ensures that newly eligible 18-year-olds are registered and deceased or migrated citizens are removed from the roll.

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
 (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
 (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false.
 (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

SECTION B: EVIDENTIARY PROOFS & MECHANISMS (Q.11 TO Q.18) [8 MARKS]**Q.11**

Assertion (A): The Election Commission of India (ECI) operates as an independent constitutional body free from executive government control.

Reason (R): Article 324 of the Constitution vests the superintendence, direction, and control of all elections in the Election Commission.

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
 (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
 (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false.
 (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.12

Assertion (A): The ruling government can unilaterally dismiss the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) of India at any time without parliamentary involvement.

Reason (R): The CEC enjoys security of tenure and can only be removed from office through impeachment by both Houses of Parliament with a special majority on grounds of proved misbehavior or incapacity.

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
 (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
 (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false.
 (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.13

Assertion (A): During general elections, the Model Code of Conduct (MCC) comes into force immediately upon the announcement of election dates by the ECI.

Reason (R): The MCC prevents the ruling party from misusing official government machinery, vehicles, and state advertisements to gain an unfair advantage.

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
 (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
 (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false.
 (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.14

Assertion (A): Under election laws in India, political parties are permitted to appeal to voters in the name of religion and caste.

Reason (R): Section 123 of the Representation of the People Act, 1951 classifies appeals to religion, race, caste, community, or religious symbols as corrupt electoral practices.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.15

Assertion (A): During elections, civil servants and police personnel on election duty operate under the administrative control of the Election Commission rather than their state governments.

Reason (R): Statutory deputation to the ECI ensures that local government officials perform their polling duties impartially without fear of political retaliation by ruling ministers.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.16

Assertion (A): Electronic Voting Machines (EVMs) used in Indian elections are connected to the central internet network to transmit votes in real time.

Reason (R): Indian EVMs are standalone offline microcontrollers with write-once software that are never connected to the internet, Wi-Fi, or Bluetooth networks.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.17

Assertion (A): The Voter Verifiable Paper Audit Trail (VVPAT) unit provides an independent verification mechanism for EVM voting.

Reason (R): When a voter presses a candidate button, the VVPAT prints a paper slip showing the candidate's serial number, name, and symbol for 7 seconds behind a glass window.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.18

Assertion (A): The Election Commission of India has the authority to order a repoll in specific polling booths if booth capturing or electoral malpractice is detected.

Reason (R): The ECI is legally empowered to countermand elections and order fresh polling to ensure that the outcome reflects genuine popular will.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

SECTION C: ADVANCED NUANCES & INSTITUTIONAL COMPLEXITIES (Q.19 TO Q.25) [7 MARKS]**Q.19**

Assertion (A): In India, poor, illiterate, and underprivileged citizens vote in a higher proportion than affluent and educated elites.

Reason (R): In Western democracies like the USA, voter turnout is typically higher among wealthy and educated citizens, whereas Indian marginalized classes view voting as their most potent tool to extract welfare entitlements.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.20

Assertion (A): Incumbent political parties in India always win reelection comfortably across successive elections.

Reason (R): In India, ruling parties regularly lose elections at both the national and state levels, demonstrating the genuine competitive fluidity and power of the electorate.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.21

Assertion (A): Money power and criminal connections present severe challenges to free and fair elections in India.

Reason (R): Wealthy candidates and parties spend disproportionate resources on publicity and logistics, making it extremely difficult for honest, resource-poor candidates to compete on an equal footing.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.22

Assertion (A): Dynastic succession in political parties undermines internal party democracy.

Reason (R): When top party positions and election tickets are monopolized by a single family, talented ordinary party cadres are denied fair leadership opportunities.

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.23

Assertion (A): The NOTA (None of the Above) option on EVMs was introduced following a Supreme Court directive in 2013.

Reason (R): NOTA provides voters with the constitutional freedom of negative voting to express disapproval of all candidates contesting in their constituency.

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.24

Assertion (A): If NOTA receives the highest number of votes in an Indian constituency, the election is automatically nullified and reheld without those candidates.

Reason (R): Under current Indian electoral law, NOTA votes are counted as invalid votes, and the candidate with the highest number of valid votes among the remaining contestants is declared the winner.

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.25

Assertion (A): Free and fair elections serve as the bedrock of constitutional democracy in India.

Reason (R): Elections provide a legitimate, peaceful mechanism for the transfer of sovereign state power according to the sovereign will of the people.

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

CBSE CANDIDATE OMR ANSWER RESPONSE GRID (SET D)

01	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	02	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	03	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	04	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	05	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
06	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	07	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	08	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	09	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	10	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
11	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	12	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	13	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	14	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	15	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
16	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	17	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	18	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	19	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	20	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
21	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	22	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	23	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	24	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	25	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D

Total Questions Attempted: ____ / 25

Marks Obtained: ____ / 25

Evaluator's Signature: _____

OFFICIAL ANSWER KEY & HISTORICAL/GEOGRAPHICAL CAUSAL EXPLANATIONS (SET D)

Q. No.	Correct	Causal Rationale & Conceptual Explanation
Q.1	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains the institutional necessity of elections in representative governance.
Q.2	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and defines the operational mechanics of the plurality voting system used in Lok Sabha elections.
Q.3	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains the constitutional objective of demographic constituency equality.
Q.4	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and articulates the affirmative action rationale behind reserved constituencies.
Q.5	(D)	Assertion is false: All registered citizens vote regardless of caste. Reason is true: The reservation applies strictly to candidate eligibility, not the electorate.
Q.6	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and provides the constitutional amendment history that expanded the franchise.
Q.7	(D)	Assertion is false: Convicted persons sentenced to 2+ years are legally disqualified. Reason is true: Section 8 RPA mandates electoral disqualification upon conviction.
Q.8	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains the Supreme Court's public interest objective in mandating electoral candidate affidavits.
Q.9	(D)	Assertion is false: Voting age is 18 while candidacy age is 25. Reason is true: The Constitution sets different age thresholds for franchise and candidacy.
Q.10	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains why dynamic roll revision is necessary for electoral accuracy.
Q.11	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and cites the constitutional foundation establishing the institutional autonomy of the ECI.
Q.12	(D)	Assertion is false: The executive cannot unilaterally remove the CEC. Reason is true: The CEC's removal procedure is identical to that of a Supreme Court judge.
Q.13	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains the level-playing-field objective enforced by the Model Code of Conduct.
Q.14	(D)	Assertion is false: Religious and caste appeals are illegal corrupt practices. Reason is true: Section 123 of the RPA strictly prohibits identity-based electoral appeals.
Q.15	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains the operational mechanism preserving the integrity of field-level polling administration.
Q.16	(D)	Assertion is false: EVMs are completely offline standalone devices. Reason is true: Lack of wireless or internet connectivity prevents remote hacking.
Q.17	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and details how the VVPAT physical slip enables voter verification and physical audit capability.
Q.18	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and describes the plenary statutory powers of the ECI to protect election sanctity.
Q.19	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and contrasts Indian participatory political culture with Western demographic turnout patterns.
Q.20	(D)	Assertion is false: Indian incumbents lose roughly half the time. Reason is true: Frequent electoral turnover proves that elections in India are genuinely competitive.

Q. No.	Correct	Causal Rationale & Conceptual Explanation
Q.21	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and identifies a major systemic challenge to electoral equality in India.
Q.22	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and highlights how nepotism impedes genuine democratic contestation within party organizations.
Q.23	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains the democratic principle behind the introduction of NOTA.
Q.24	(D)	Assertion is false: NOTA does not trigger repolls in Lok Sabha contests under current rules. Reason is true: The highest polling human candidate wins regardless of NOTA tally.
Q.25	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and summarizes the supreme philosophical purpose of democratic elections.